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Culture (OWC): [San \(FX10\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Southern Africa

Field Date: 1968-1970

Coverage Date: 1921-1974

Place Coverage: Ghanzi District, Botswana

Section Title(S): Contact And Conflict

In their reactions, of rising disillusionment and resentment, the farm Bushmen display little overt aggression toward the dominant Europeans. The absence of aggressive reactions to dominance can be explained in terms of the condition of marginality and, more specifically, dependence of the farm Bushmen on the dominant group. Carstens (1971:141–43) has noted this paradoxical psychological reaction in other situations of dependence and dominance—among South African and Canadian reserve dwellers—and discusses a variety of mechanisms of curbing aggression (such as joking behaviour between members of the two groups, work sabotage, and direction of overt aggression unto members of ones own group). If the Ghanzi farm Bushmen were to antagonize the Europeans by relating toward them aggressively, they would jeopardize their acquisition of European-controlled work, food and water, as [167](#) well as their chance of entry into the life conditions of the European group, which many admire and emulate in spite of all resentment.

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